

so that you can inexpensively expand the device's internal storage (but not RAM). Today, these mini memory cards typically range in size from 2 GB to 32 GB of storage. But of course! Technology improves with time.

- ▶ **Ultra-high resolution screens:** At the time of this writing, the iPhone 4 supports a resolution of 960x640, which exceeds the highest resolution supported by Windows Phone? While there's little doubt that the Windows Phone OS could handle higher resolutions, device makers are prohibited from selling such a device at this time. As Microsoft evolves the Windows Phone hardware requirements over time, this limitation will change.
- ▶ **Gyroscope:** While Windows Phone supports an accelerometer, it lacks a gyroscope – a hardware component found in the iPhone 4. In simple words – because this is complicated stuff – a gyroscope simply provides a more accurate, or more sensitive, measurement of how the device is being rotated in X, Y or Z axis (or “directions”). Given the relatively non-subtle hand movements that will be typical in human/phone interaction, we don't consider a gyroscope to be a particularly important improvement over an accelerometer and its loss won't impact the Windows Phone experience – gaming or otherwise.
- ▶ **Video recording:** While Microsoft doesn't specify that the Windows Phone camera be able to record video, virtually all Windows Phones do, in fact, ship with this capability. Expect VGA (640p) or HD (720p) or better video recording capabilities.
- ▶ **Geo-tagging:** Another neat camera feature, geo-tagging allows your camera to optionally “tag” each photo with location data so that you can later discover on a map, where exactly the photo was taken. This capability is absolutely possible with Windows Phone, thanks to its built-in GPS and other location sensors, and is in fact a feature of the built-in camera software.
- ▶ **Headphone jack, microphone and external speaker:** While Microsoft doesn't require Windows Phone hardware makers to include a standard headphone jack, microphone or external speaker(s) on its devices, most of course will do so. Be sure to look for these features, however.